

How the News Media Activate Public Expression and Influence National Agendas¹

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¹Based on joint work with Benjamin Schneer and Ariel White (*Science* 2017)

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Research Design

Results

Supporting Analyses

Implications

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- Establish 11 broad *policy areas*
 - Rules: (a) major national importance; (b) interest to outlets
 - race, immigration, jobs, abortion, climate, food policy, water, education policy, refugees, domestic energy production, and reproductive rights

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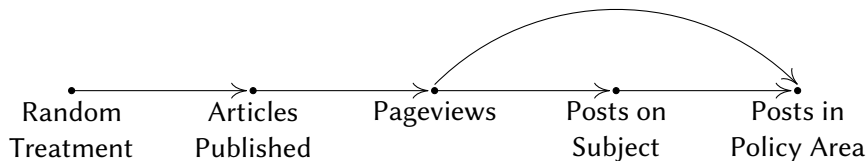
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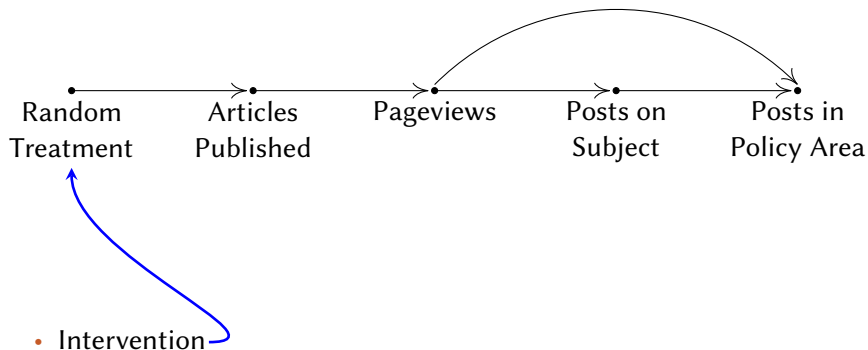
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- **(Ex post:** Automated text analysis & qualitative evidence: indistinguishable from normal publications & practices; no outlet received a single complaint)

Quantities of Interest (& observable implications)

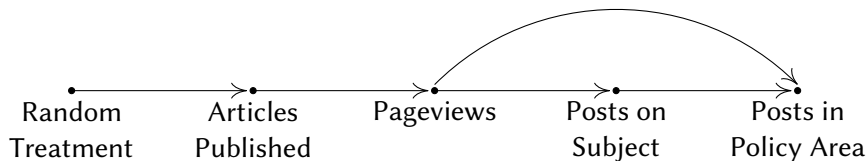
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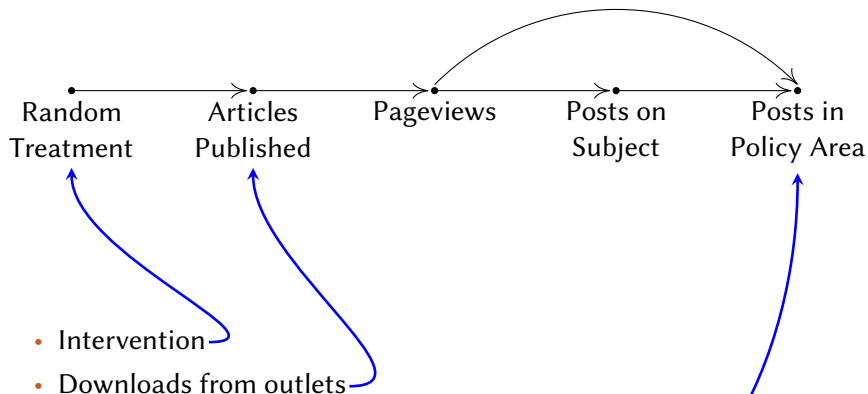
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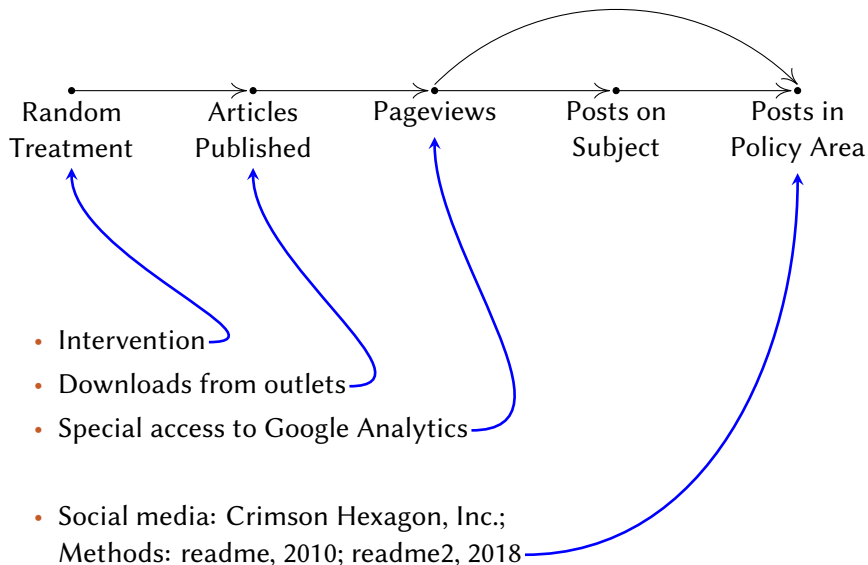
- Intervention

- Social media: Crimson Hexagon, Inc.;
Methods: readme, 2010; readme2, 2018

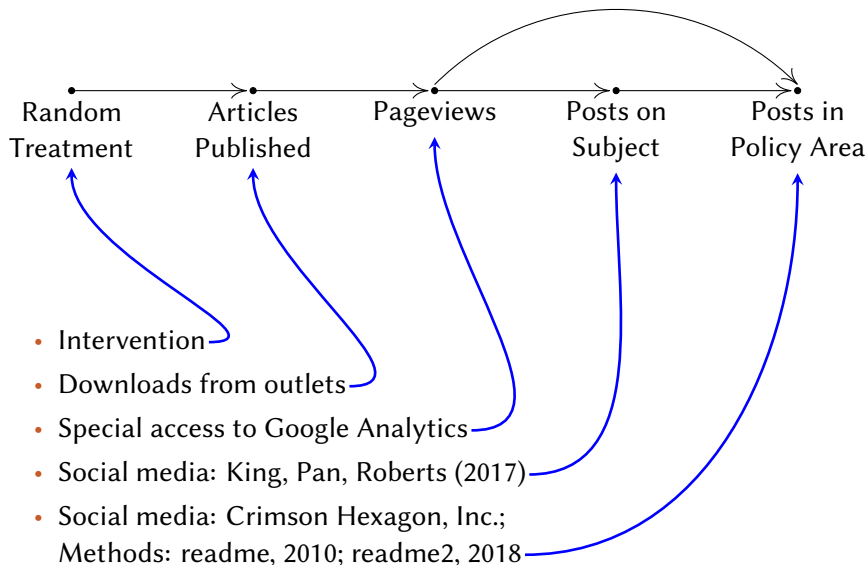
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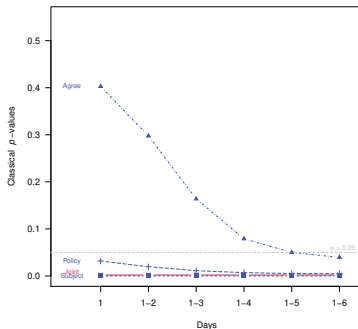
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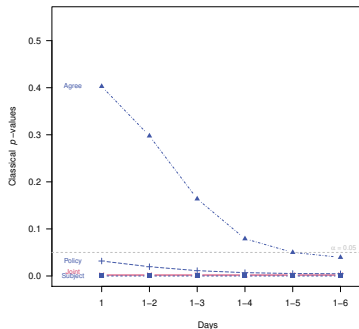
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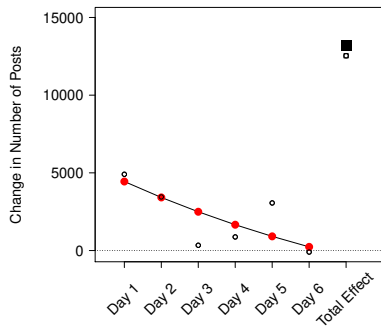
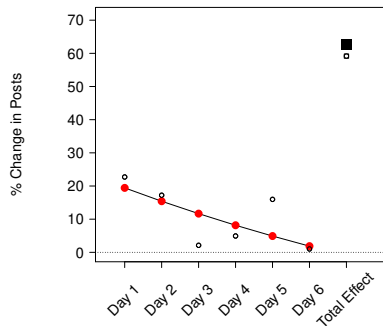
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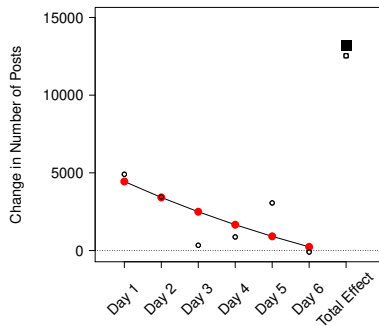
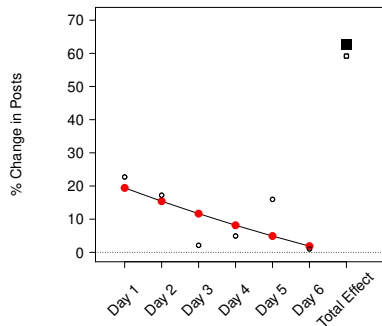
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Main Causal Effect: Public Expression in Policy Areas

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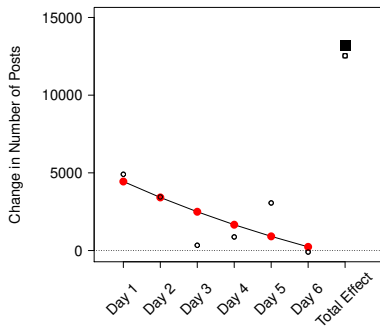
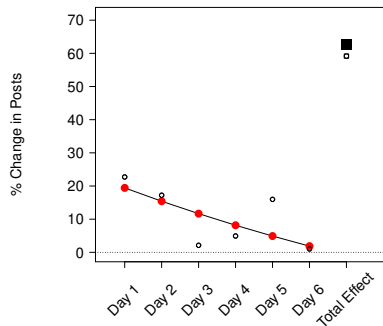


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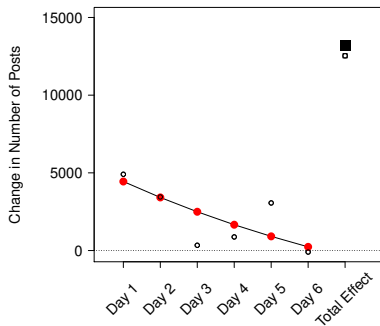
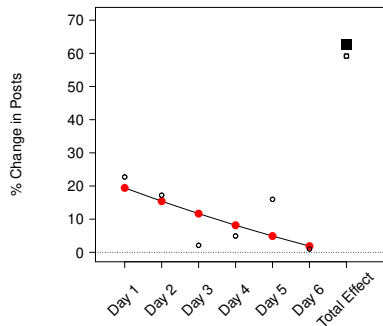
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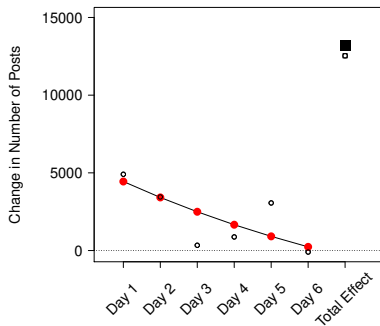
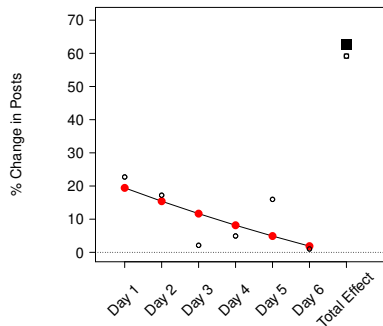
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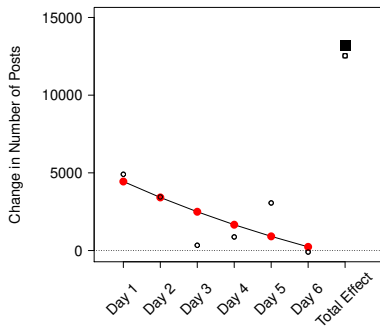
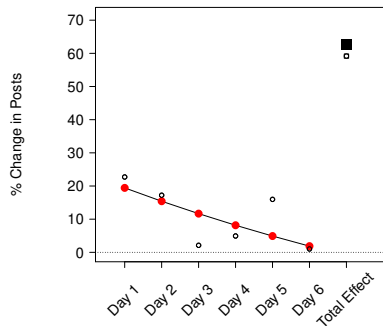
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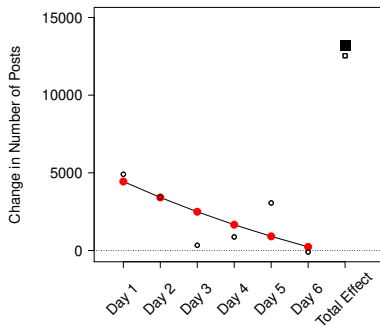
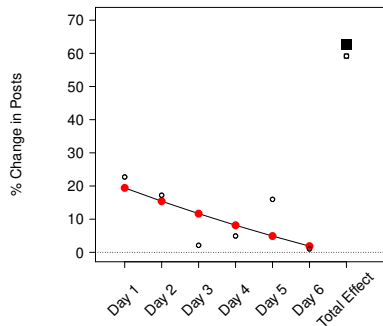
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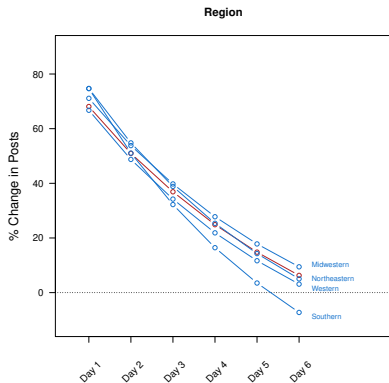
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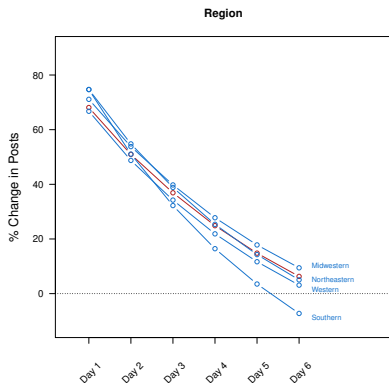
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- **Context:** 3 small media outlets have huge effect on the national conversation

Causal Effect: Indistinguishable Across Subgroups

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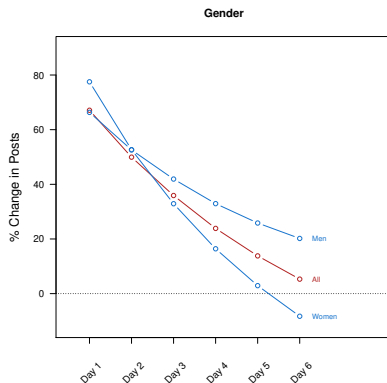


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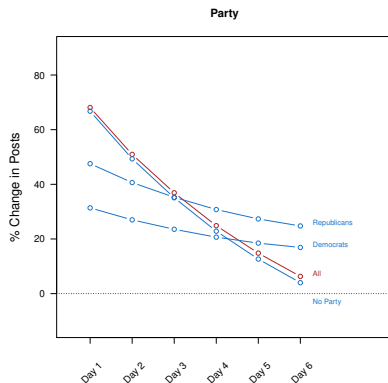
Effect on the national conversation in major policy areas is national

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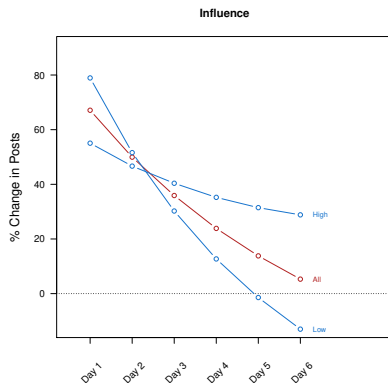
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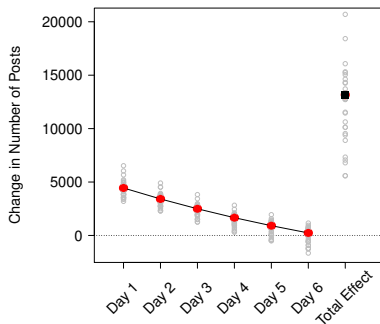


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Causal Heterogeneity: Leave-One-Outlet-Out

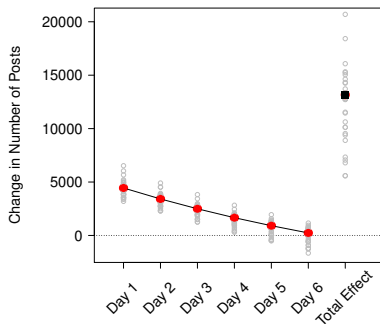
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Jackknife Estimation on Policy Area Effects



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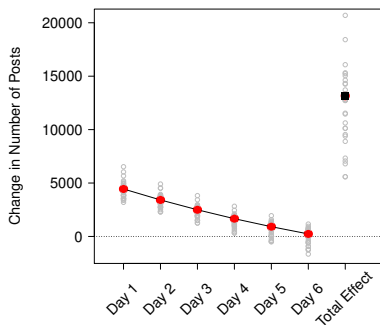
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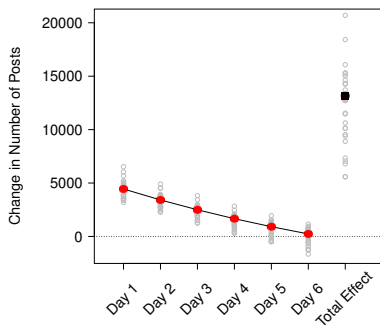
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- **Results:** no dominant outlet; high heterogeneity

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Research Design

Results

Supporting Analyses

Implications

High Experimental Compliance

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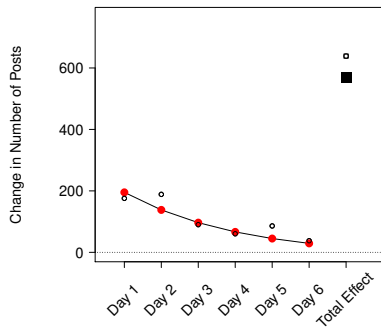
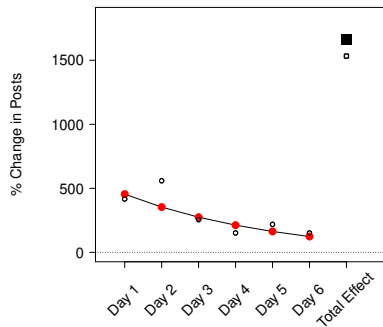
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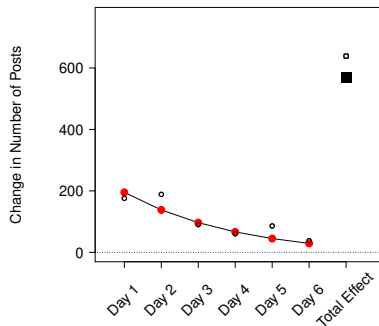
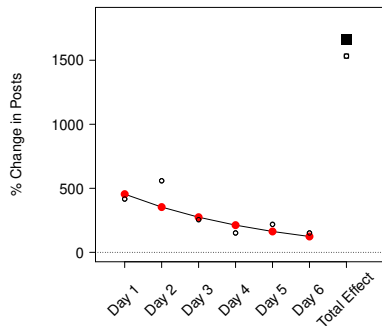
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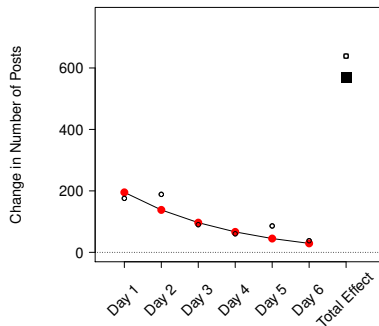
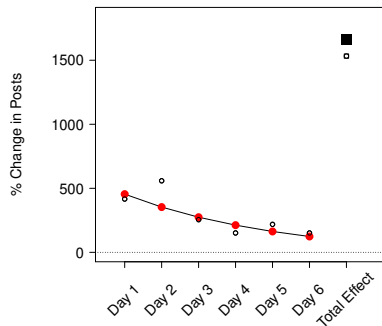


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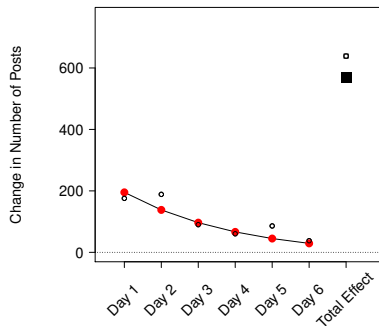
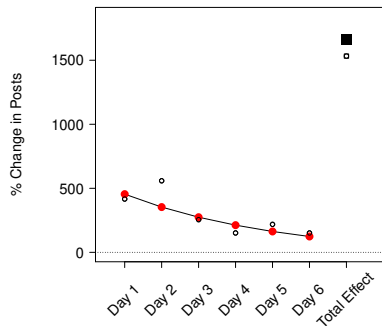
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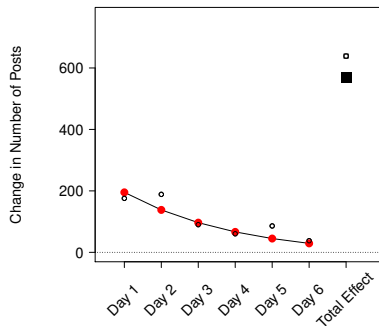
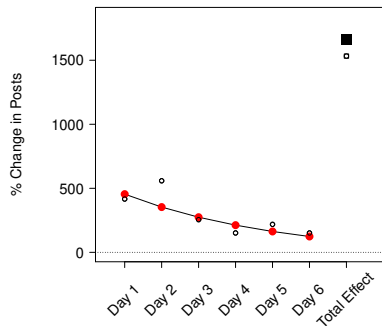
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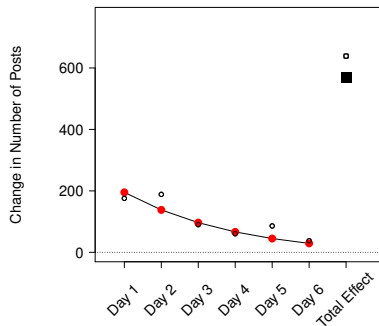
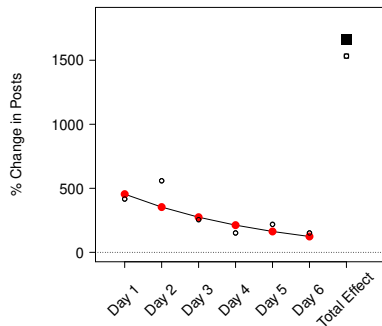
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- [More Results](#)

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 - Treatment articles: representative of all on complexity, type

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For more information:

GaryKing.org/media

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- Equivalent to difference in means for each day
- (perhaps with policy fixed effects)